

RP2. Design and innovation processes - Scripts and configuring users

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↗ Parent item	📚 CM2010 Lecture 2

The purpose of the short reaction paper is to summarise, analyse and reflect the content of the lecture in relation to own field of study, user study or interests. Short reaction paper consists of 1) introducing and summarising the main content of the lecture, and presenting and explaining key concepts 2) discussing the ideas and arguments presenting in the lecture and 3) connecting the content of the lecture to your own field of study, user study or interests. The length of the short reaction paper is 1-2 pages (500-1000 words).

Reaction Paper: Adoption and Use of Digital Technologies in Everyday Life and Organisational Contexts

On Tuesday, March, 24, the lecture focused on how digital technologies are adopted and used in everyday life. It highlighted that technology does not influence society simply by existing; it must be understood, accepted, and integrated into everyday practices. The lecture covered several key concepts: internet use and non-use in Sweden, technology adaption models, social shaping of technology, domestication theory, uses and gratifications theory, and examples from health and welfare technology. A central takeaway was that people's use of technology is strongly shaped by their goals, expectations, intentions, social environment, and previous experiences. I found it especially interesting that the lecture explored technology use at both the individual and societal levels, as well as the different purposes for which technologies are adopted.

In a unique survey of internet use in Sweden conducted by the Swedish Internet Foundation in 2024, the findings showed that significant inequalities remain despite high overall internet use, particularly in relation to gender, older adults, and individuals in need of digital assistance. This is meaningful because it challenges the assumption that innovation, technology, and digitalization automatically reach everyone and create personal and societal impact. Similar patterns are evident in Internetstiftelsen's 2024 publication on Swedes and AI, which indicates that the adoption and perceived relevance of AI are unevenly distributed across the Swedish population. For instance, among the various AI tools currently available, a relatively large proportion of users (29%) use ChatGPT, whereas only a very small proportion (2%) use Midjourney. While identifying this distinction is important, it is also worth noting that the percentages presented — at least on the sixth lecture slide — do not sum to 100, which may suggest that other AI tools are included but not explicitly shown. In addition, the figure illustrate only the proportion of users who report using a specific AI tool — not *why* they use it or for *what* purposes. Such questions are central to any discussion of technology adoption and its broader impact. Furthermore, in reality, access is not the same as meaningful use. This issue could be seen in the examples about AI and care technologies, where age, experience, and attitude influence whether a person feels comfortable using a digital tool. For me, this highlights that digital exclusion is not only a technical issue but also a social and practical one.

The lecture also introduced two technology adoption models, Technology acceptance model (TAM) and Unified theory of acceptance and use of technology (UTAUT), that explain adoption through concepts of perceived usefulness, perceived ease of use, performance expectancy, effort expectancy, social influence, and facilitating conditions. I think these models are valuable because they provide a structured way to understand why some technologies are accepted and others are rejected. At the same time, as they explain important factors, these models, do not fully capture the emotional, cultural, and relational side of technology use.

On the contrary, domestication theory adds a missing layer to this understanding. It explains how technologies become part of daily life through four stages: *appropriation* (i.e., understanding its purpose and function), *objectification* (i.e., interpreted it in life settings), *incorporation* (i.e., adapt it to own habits, timing, needs, and practical routines), and *conversion* (i.e., it influences how one lives and acts). Personally, I like this framework because it shows that adaptation is not a single decision but an on-going process. As its purpose is to enhance daily life, a technology needs time to be integrated into one's life — thus, it is deeply personal. For instance, two people may use the same tool in completely different ways and experience completely different outcomes.

In relation to my own field of study, medical engineering, the lecture felt highly relevant. As a medical engineering student, I often think about innovation in terms of function, accuracy, efficiency, and technical performance. However, this lecture reminded me that even the most advanced medical technology has limited value if users do not trust it, understand it, or see a place for it in their everyday routines or professional practice. This is especially important in healthcare, where technologies are used by different groups (e.g., patients, clinicians, caregivers, and administrators) whose needs are not always the same. A device may be clinically effective, but still fail if it is difficult to use, emotionally uncomfortable, or poorly integrated into the care environment. For me, one of the most valuable lessons from the lecture was that adoption is not only about acceptance at the beginning, but also about long-term meaning, routine, and context.